GOALGO FOR NINJATRADER 8

OrderBlocks

User guide · version 1.0.23

> **Risk notice.** Futures trading involves substantial risk of loss. goAlgo indicators mark possible setups and their historical outcomes on the chart; past results do not guarantee future results. goAlgo TradeDesk can place real orders on the account you select. Learn every tool on a **Sim** account before using it with real money. Nothing in this package is investment advice.

1. What is in this package

Indicator	What it does
goAlgoSetupEngine	Finds graded reversal setups at areas of interest, draws entry, stop and target, and tracks every signal to its result so you can scroll back through the chart as a visual backtest.
goVolumeStrengthSpotter	High and medium volume bars (used on the template chart).
goAlgo Core (shared with goAlgo TradeMatrix)	
goICTOrderBlocks	Bullish and bearish order blocks.
goBuysideSellsideLiquidityV2	Buyside / sellside liquidity lines, the zones left when they are run, and liquidity voids.
goOrderFlowPro, goOrderFlowSignals	Order flow imbalances, stacked-imbalance support / resistance zones and footprint, built from tick data (no Tick Replay needed).
goAlgoMTFLiquiditySweepScannerMSFilterV4	Liquidity sweeps on the chart and four higher timeframes, with the MS Trend Matrix filter (uses MSTrendMatrixGoAlgoV2).
goAlgoGEXLevels	Daily GEX levels (FLIP, ±G1–G4, CW, PW) from the GEX file you receive.
goAlgoTradeDesk	Chart side panel for order entry and management, with optional automatic entries from the setup engine.

The installer also adds the chart template **MNQ 1 min Order Blocks Trader**.

2. Installation

1. Run **goAlgo-OrderBlocks-Setup-1.0.23.exe**. It places two import files and this guide in `Documents\goAlgo\OrderBlocks`, installs the chart template, and opens that folder.
2. Close NinjaTrader before running the installer. Older goAlgo source files (.cs) that would clash with this version are moved to `Documents\goAlgo\backup\<date>` automatically.

3. In NinjaTrader: **Control Center** > **Tools** > **Import** > **NinjaScript Add-On**. Choose `goAlgoCore_1.0.23.zip` first. Answer **Yes** if asked to replace an older version.
4. Import `goAlgoOrderBlocks_1.0.23.zip` the same way.
5. Restart NinjaTrader.

> Already using goAlgo TradeMatrix? Both products share goAlgo Core. Import Core again only when this package's version is newer.

Tick data. Order flow (stacked imbalances, order flow zones) is built from tick history. Download it for your instrument in **Control Center** > **Tools** > **Historical Data** (Tick, for the days you load on the chart).

3. License

1. Open **Control Center** > **New** > **goAlgo License**.
2. Click **Copy** next to the Machine ID and send it with your license request.
3. Paste the key you receive (it starts with `GOALGO-`), click **Add key**, then reload open charts (F5).

Club keys run for 60 days. Without a valid key the indicators show an orange notice on the chart and do nothing. The window lists your keys with their products and expiry dates.

4. Load the chart template

1. Open a chart, right-click it > **Templates** > **Load** > **MNQ 1 min Order Blocks Trader**.
2. Set the instrument to the current contract (the template was saved on a specific expiry).
3. TradeDesk starts on the **Sim101** account. Choose your account in the panel when you are ready.
4. Set the GEX file (section 5).

5. GEX levels

The day's GEX levels are published each morning (from about 7:30 ET, refreshed at 9:15 ET) to a shared Google Drive folder, **goAlgo GEX**. Set it up once and your charts update by themselves.

1. Add the folder to your own Drive. A shared folder stays under *Shared with me*, which Google Drive for desktop does not show on your PC, so it needs a shortcut in **My Drive**:
   - Go to **drive.google.com**, signed in with the Google account the folder was shared with.
   - Open **Shared with me**, right-click **goAlgo GEX** > **Organize** > **Add shortcut** and choose **My Drive**. (From the share link you can also click the folder name > **Organize** > **Add shortcut**.)
   - Check that **goAlgo GEX** now appears in **My Drive**, with a small arrow on its icon.
2. Install **Google Drive for desktop** (google.com/drive/download) and sign in with the **same** Google account. It adds a **Google Drive (G:)** drive to File Explorer.
3. In File Explorer you should now see `G:\My Drive\goAlgo GEX\` with files such as `NQFutures_Intraday_SR_Lines_ETH_schwab.csv` (NQ / MNQ), `ES…` and `RTY…`. Right-click the folder > **Offline access** > **Available offline** so NinjaTrader can always read it.

4. The chart template already points **goAlgoGEXLevels** to `G:\My Drive\goAlgo GEX\`. If Google Drive uses another drive letter on your PC, change *GEX file folder* to match. Use the file for your instrument in *GEX file name*.

Each file holds every day so far, so scrolling back shows each day's own levels. When the morning file arrives, the chart picks it up within seconds; the setup engine reads the same file.

6. How the setup engine works

Areas of interest

Primary (PAOI)	Secondary (SAOI)
Order blocks Liquidity zones (a buyside / sellside level that price has run) Liquidity voids	GEX levels Order flow support / resistance zones Buyside / sellside liquidity lines (not yet run)

Grade	Meaning
A+	A primary and a secondary area within *Confluence ticks* of each other, on the same side of the trade.
A	Primary area only.
B	Secondary area only.

The setup, step by step

1. **Touch** – price trades into the area (for a long, it comes down into a bullish area).
2. **Break back out** – within *Max bars after touch*, a bar closes back beyond the area's edge in the trade direction (a long never fires on a red bar, a short never on a green bar).
3. **Trigger** – that bar shows the selected trigger: high volume, stacked imbalance, a liquidity sweep, or a combination (see *Trigger* and *Liquidity sweep* in the settings, including *AnyTwoOfThree*).
4. **Entry** – at the close of that bar. A small-bodied (doji) trigger bar uses a stop order just beyond its high or low instead.

Reading the chart

On the chart	Meaning
Triangle with **BUY** / **SELL**	A signal. Next to it: what triggered it (e.g. `HV 1.8x`, `SI 3`, `Sweep`), then the grade and the areas involved.
Green / red boxes and lines	Target (reward) and stop (risk) from the entry. Labels show prices, ticks and R:R.
Dashed outlines	The area the trade came from (long / short colour) and the confluence areas (grey).
WIN / LOSS	Where the target or stop was reached. A bar that reaches both is counted as a loss.
WATCH box	An area price has touched; the engine is waiting for the break-out bar and trigger.
Panel (top left)	Trigger in use, sources, areas in play, and signals / win rate / net R per grade for the bars loaded.

Settings you are most likely to change

Setting	Default	What it does
Trade setups from / Minimum grade	Both / B	Which areas to trade and the lowest grade shown.
Minimum areas in confluence	1 (off)	How many different kinds of area (order block, void, liquidity zone or line, order flow zone, GEX) must be stacked within *Confluence ticks* where the trade is taken.
Trigger	HV + SI within 3 bars	High volume, stacked imbalance, either, or both.
Liquidity sweep	Off	Add sweeps as a trigger: also triggers, required, sweep only, or any two of three.
Stacked imbalance levels	3	Consecutive imbalance price levels needed.
Trigger bar must be at the area	On	The trigger bar or the one before must trade into the area.
Edge tolerance ticks	1	A close this close to the edge counts as beyond it.
Stop – primary / void / secondary	Zone middle / zone middle / trigger bar	Where the stop goes for each kind of area.
Target	2 R	Risk:reward multiple or fixed ticks.
Maximum area age (bars)	300	Older areas no longer produce signals.
Minimum area age at touch / Minimum touch depth	Off / off	Ignore retests that come too soon after an area forms, or that only reach its edge (e.g. 50% = the midline).
Sync settings from chart	On	The engine uses the settings of the indicators on the chart, so the areas you see are the areas it trades. Press F5 after changing them.

Display switches (group 5): risk / reward boxes, price labels, trigger label, area outlines, explain missed signals.

7. TradeDesk (order panel)

goAlgoTradeDesk adds a side panel to the right of the chart for placing and managing trades on the chart's instrument, by hand or automatically from goAlgoSetupEngine. It is on the template chart; on another chart add it like any indicator (**Indicators** > **goAlgoTradeDesk**). The panel shows only while its chart tab is selected.

> TradeDesk sends real orders to the account selected in the panel. It starts on **Sim101**; learn it there first. Removing the indicator or closing the chart leaves working stops and targets in place.

The main panel, top to bottom

Part	What it does
Close Only	While on, new entries are blocked. Flatten All and the exit buttons still work.
Position strip	Position, last price, open P&L and the day's P&L. Click the open P&L to show it in $, ticks, points or %.
Account	The account the panel trades. An orange line warns when Chart Trader on the same chart is on a different account, and **UNPROTECTED** appears when contracts have no stop; the **Add stop** button then places one.
Order Management	*Order Type* for manual entries (Market, Limit or Stop Market, with an offset in ticks); *QTY Type* **Auto** (size from a dollar risk) or **Fixed** (a set number of contracts); *Max qty*; up to four targets in R:R or ticks with the share of the position each one closes (T4 takes the rest); the *Stop Loss* source and *Min stop ticks*. The lines below show the size, stop and targets an entry would get right now.
Manual Entries	**Enter Long / Enter Short**, and buy / sell **lines** that enter when price reaches the chosen bar level (high / low, close, open). Options: enter only on a bar close, only on a bar closing your way, or on a breakout of the previous bar.
Auto Entries	**AUTO** on / off, **REV** (an opposite signal reverses the trade), and **LONG** / **SHORT** to take one side only. The lines below show the session window, trades taken so far, and whether Auto is waiting for a signal or blocked, with the reason.
Order Controls	**Flatten All**; **Flat 1–4** close one target's share at market; **Add** contracts to the position; move targets or the stop by a number of ticks; **TP %** moves the stop to lock in that share of the open profit and **SL %** moves it that share of the way toward price; four **breakeven** buttons (entry plus ticks) and four **trail** buttons. The small arrows beside a button change its tick value. In any number box you can type a value and press Enter (Esc puts the old one back), or use the arrows, the Up / Down keys or the mouse wheel.

Stop Loss choices

- **Ticks** – a fixed distance from the entry.
- **Bar high / low** – beyond the lowest low (long) or highest high (short) of the last *Candles to scan* bars, starting *Bars ago* back, plus an offset. While you are flat, dashed lines on the chart show where each side's stop would go and which candles it uses.
- **An indicator plot** on the chart, plus an offset. Shorts use the same plot, or pick another one under *Short stop plot* (for example a zone's bottom for longs and its top for shorts).

With *QTY Type: Auto* the contracts are *Risk $* divided by the stop distance, never more than *Max qty*. *Min stop ticks* keeps a very close stop from producing a very large position.

The drawer tabs

The tab strip on the panel's left edge opens a settings drawer beside the panel. Drag the grip at the far left to make the panel wider or narrower.

Tab	What is there
FEED	The source for Auto: **goAlgoSetupEngine**, with the lowest grade to take (B, A or A+; default A), whether to use the engine's stop, and whether T1 uses the engine's target (its WIN +xR, measured from your fill and stop). The FEED tab shows only the filters the selected engine offers. Or **Plot conditions**: entry, exit and on / off filter rules built from any indicator plot on the chart. Beside *Auto* on the main panel: **REV** (an opposite signal closes the trade and enters the other way) and **OPP** (an opposite signal only closes the trade, manual or auto, even when the guards would block a new entry; it works with Auto off too, watching the FEED engine's signals; the backtest simulates it).
GUARD	Limits for Auto: trading sessions (or All day), up to four skip windows (lunch, news), days of the week to trade, daily loss and profit kill switches, per-trade and account kill switches, trades per day, winners / losers per day and in a row, signal bar size, bar / time exits, cooldown, and the 8:30 ET and 4:00 ET safety windows, and an optional opening safety: no new entries from 9:28 ET until a set number of minutes after the 9:30 ET open (off by default, 30 minutes). A kill switch turns Auto off and Close Only on until the next trading day. *Apply entry filters to manual entries* (off by default) makes your own entries obey the same limits. *Use filters* at the top switches all of them on or off; while it is off the rest of the tab is greyed out.
ENTRY	Bars used for the entry lines, and the chart lines / stop preview switches.
STOPS	Auto breakeven (up to four steps, by ticks of profit or a target filling), auto trail, maximum stop and target distances, *Skip stops under* (refuses an entry whose stop is too close instead of widening it), *Skip stops from / to* (refuses an entry whose stop distance falls in a tick range), cancelling a resting entry that has not filled, stop / target time in force (GTC or Day), and the type of each trail: ticks behind price, previous bar high / low, ATR, or an indicator plot.
SCALE	Rules for the Add button, e.g. add only when the position is in profit (some prop firms do not allow averaging down).
STATS	Results of your live trades or a backtest, breakdowns by entry hour and weekday, a comparison with engine style, and a prop firm simulator. See *STATS* below.
LOG	What the panel did and why. Also written to `Documents\NinjaTrader 8\goAlgo\logs\TradeDesk_<date>.txt`.
SAVE	Saved settings: type a name and press *Save settings* to keep every setting of the panel; pick a name and press *Load* to switch to it at once (only while flat, with no working entry order or armed line). Use it to switch between ways of trading, or to compare them in STATS. The account and *Backtest only - no live entries* are not saved. The files are in Documents\NinjaTrader 8\goAlgo\TradeDesk settings; *Open the folder* shows them, to copy or share.

Auto entries

1. On FEED, choose the source (goAlgoSetupEngine on this chart) and the minimum grade.
2. Check GUARD, at least the session window, daily loss limit and trades per day (defaults 9:30–16:00 chart time, $500, 5 trades).
3. Click **AUTO**. Auto is **always off** after the chart loads or reloads, and only acts on signals that appear while it is on.

Auto entries are market orders. With *Use the signal's stop* on (the default) the stop is the engine's; targets always come from the panel.

STATS: results, comparison and breakdowns

Choose *Results of* (your live trades on the account, or a backtest of the FEED source on the bars loaded) and the *Period*, then click **Refresh**. The table shows the usual figures for all trades, longs and shorts. The backtest uses the panel's current settings: size, stop, targets, breakeven and the GUARD limits, one trade at a time.

Section	What it shows
Max drawdown in R	In the table: the worst drawdown counted in R (one R = what a trade stood to lose at its stop), as if every trade risked the same dollars. With *QTY Type: Auto* a drawdown costs about this many R × *Risk $*; this is why Auto at $300 can show a far bigger dollar drawdown than one fixed contract on the same trades. Backtest only.
Risk $ for a drawdown	Enter the drawdown you can take (e.g. well inside a prop firm's trailing loss) and click **Find the size**. It backtests the FEED source at a range of sizes for your QTY Type (Risk $ for Auto, contracts for Fixed) with all your other settings, lists each size's trades, net and max drawdown (red: over your limit) and marks the best net that fits. **Use this size** sets it and runs the backtest again. With Auto and a low *Max qty*, Risk $ cannot size up and mostly decides which trades are skipped; the line says so. Switch QTY Type and run it again to compare Auto with Fixed. Leave room: the next drawdown can be deeper than the worst so far.
By entry	Trades, win %, net and drawdown per group (grade, setup type, or Auto / manual for live trades).
By entry hour	Trades, net, win % and average per trade for each hour the trades were entered (chart time). Shows the hours that earn and the hours that cost.
By day of week	The same per trading day, Monday first (an evening session counts toward the next day). To stop Auto trading on a day, untick it on **GUARD > Days**.
By stop size	The trades split by the stop's distance from the entry, in ticks, into five groups of about the same size, tightest first. If the tight groups lose, set **STOPS > Skip stops under** to the low end of the first group that earns; if groups in the middle lose, set **Skip stops from / to** to their tick range (e.g. 102 to 196). Load more history first: about 40 trades a group is a small sample. Backtest only.
First half vs second half	The trades cut in two at the middle date of the period, with trades, win %, net, R and drawdown for each half. A setting worth keeping helps in both halves; if a change only improves one half, it is probably fitted to that stretch of the market. Load more history for bigger halves.
Compare with engine style	Click **Run comparison** to backtest the FEED source twice over the period and see the results side by side: trades, win %, net $, net R, average R, profit factor and maximum drawdown. *Your settings* – exactly as the backtest above. *Engine style* – every signal, even while another trade is open; no GUARD limits; the engine's own stop and target for the whole position; no breakeven; each trade sized to *Risk $* with no *Max qty* or stop limits. This is close to the R shown on the engine's own panel. Your settings are not changed. The difference between the columns is what your trade management and limits add or cost. **What makes the difference** splits that gap: starting from engine style it adds one of your settings at a time (one trade at a time, fill price, your targets, stop and size, breakeven, then the GUARD tab in five steps: sides and days, time and skips, limits, kill switches, signal bar) and shows net $, the change in profit that setting makes, net R and maximum drawdown after each. The changes add up to the gap between the two columns. A green figure means that setting helped, red that it cost; the last row is your settings. *Fill price* is the cost of measuring the engine's target from your actual fill (the next bar's open) instead of from the signal bar's close, as the engine's panel does.

Prop firm simulator	Plays the trades in the table through a prop firm evaluation and funded account. It reruns by itself on Refresh and whenever a prop setting changes. The bold line at the top of *Results* says where the account stands, e.g. *Evaluation in progress: $602 to the goal, $1,671 above the floor*; the timeline lists each day, with passes, blown accounts and payouts in orange.

Sections marked + are folded; click the header to open them. The backtest counts the stop first when a bar reaches both the stop and a target, and does not simulate trails, open P&L exits, or bar and time exits. It does apply the New York safety windows.

Good to know

- Stop and targets are sent together as OCO orders: when one fills, the others for that share are cancelled.
- After a reload (F5) or a restart, the panel picks up an open position and its working orders and goes on managing them.
- If the position is closed some other way (Chart Trader, another tool), the panel cancels its remaining stops and targets.
- Panel orders are named `TD …` in the Orders and Executions tabs.
- To drag the stop or targets on the chart, turn on Chart Trader for that chart (*Hidden* is enough) on the same account as the panel. The panel follows the new prices.
- Most panel values are also in the indicator's settings, so you can save them in a chart template.

8. Troubleshooting

You see	Do this
TradeDesk shows UNPROTECTED	Some contracts have no stop. Click **Add stop**, or Flatten All (section 7).
TradeDesk Auto does not take a signal	The line under the AUTO buttons shows whether Auto is blocked and why (session window, kill switch, trade limit). Also check the FEED source and its minimum grade / setup type, and the LOG tab.
Orange "no license key" or "license expired" notice	Add or renew your key (section 3), then F5.
"No order flow for recent bars"	Download tick history for the instrument (section 2).
"file not found" from goAlgoGEXLevels	Check that Google Drive for desktop is running and signed in, the GEX folder and file name (section 5). If `goAlgo GEX` is missing from `G:\My Drive`, the shortcut has not been added (section 5, step 1) or Drive is signed in with a different Google account.
Import fails with "already exists" / duplicate names	Run the installer again with NinjaTrader closed (it moves older goAlgo source files aside, section 2), then import again.
Template loads with some indicators missing	Import both goAlgo Core and goAlgo OrderBlocks, restart NinjaTrader, then load the template again.

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